



FIRST

THE STATS

5 COUPLES.
5 COMMUNITIES.
5 BUILDINGS.



BUILDING SIZE



5,000-



15,000 sq. feet

ESTIMATED AMOUNT OF JEWS IN

Makom Hashlichus

2,000 - 8,000



AMOUNT OF BUILDING MORTGAGED

0%-80%



Timeline of entire project,
from land purchase until
completed building.

2 YEARS - 12 YEARS



PROJECT BUDGET

\$850,000 *to*
\$3,800,000
MILLION



Years ON SHLICHUS
BEFORE BEGINNING PROJECT

4-13



L'CHATCHILA ARIBER: it's one of the iconic phrases inculcated in Lubavitch youth, and a message that perhaps encapsulates, more so than any other, the modus operandi of shluchim. For so many shluchim, soon after moving to a new community, the desire to have their very own space, tailor-made to their needs, takes root. The dream many carry around with them of the perfect building may seem elusive at first. But when you realize that it's the only logical "next step," you might dare to dream...and then dare to bring that dream to fruition. The excitement brought on by the prospect of going forward with plans for a new building can be intoxicating. What are some of the questions you should ask yourself if you really feel you and your community are ready to embark on a capital campaign? Are you ready to take your shlichus to a whole new level? Do you know what it takes to make the leap? ... אין חכם כבעל הנסיון. Compass Magazine spoke with a panel of shluchim and shluchos. Here's what they say you need to know:

[Disclaimer: This article only touches upon some of the factors shluchim should take into account when deciding to build. Although a few financial-related ideas which we trust you will find helpful are mentioned in this article, it does not cover financial considerations or options for financing—that is beyond the scope of this article. Also not covered in this article, but יה"א in a future one: design and material considerations.]



DREAM BIG, BUT WITH PURPOSE

"If you build it, they will come," is a nice maxim, but such advice can be reckless for shluchim thinking of building," shares Rabbi Mendy Deutsch, shliach to Chandler, Arizona. "Building a building is exciting but it's important to first dig deep and ask yourself, 'Do we really need it?' And, if yes, 'What do we *really* need?'"

Many shluchim acknowledge the "yetzer hara" that pushes shluchim to want to build. But "don't just build because you want to be like everybody else," advises Rabbi Pinchus Ciment, shliach of Chabad in Arkansas. "The time must be ripe. If you haven't outgrown your present space and don't (yet) 'feel the squeeze,' don't think that a building will do your shlichus for you." "Of course, a beautiful place enhances people's experience with Yiddishkeit," says Mrs. Esther Tiechtel. "But it's important to remember that it's still the caring and personal touch that is the core of every Chabad center."

"Form follows function" is a basic principle of Architecture 101, yet, Rabbi Tiechtel says, many shluchim are unsure of how best to allocate their square footage and resources. "When setting

out to create building plans, ask yourself, 'What are my services?'" recommends Rabbi Tiechtel. "Build a building based around your community's needs, your programs, and to whom you cater."

Rabbi Tiechtel invokes the Original Architect's building method: *Sof maaseh b'machshavah techilah*. "Think big and towards the future, of course, but stay grounded and practical," he suggests. "If there is a mikvah five miles away, you probably shouldn't bother with building another one, as much as you'd like to include one in your plans." Rabbi Tiechtel cautions, "Lots of shluchim want to build big, massive rooms because on Rosh Hashanah or Yom Kippur they have a lot of people. But does it really make sense to build a huge room that will only be filled to capacity three days a year? Think more of the day-to-day operations." Adds Rabbi Ciment, "Rabbi Chaim Gutnick of Australia once told me, 'Don't make a big shul just to feel like you have a grandiose place.' It should be aesthetically nice, of course, but don't go over the top."

Rabbi Tiechtel also suggests shluchim consider what is not being addressed in their communities. "Perhaps you are uniquely positioned to fill that lack," he says, citing an example from his own building experience. Frequent requests from visitors for lodging accommodations prompted the Tiechtels to incorporate guest suites into their building, which is more than two miles away from the nearest hotel.

The planning process definitely entails the difficult task of finding a balance between being practical and thinking big. Advice from all the shluchim interviewed for this article points to one clear message: dream big, but with purpose.



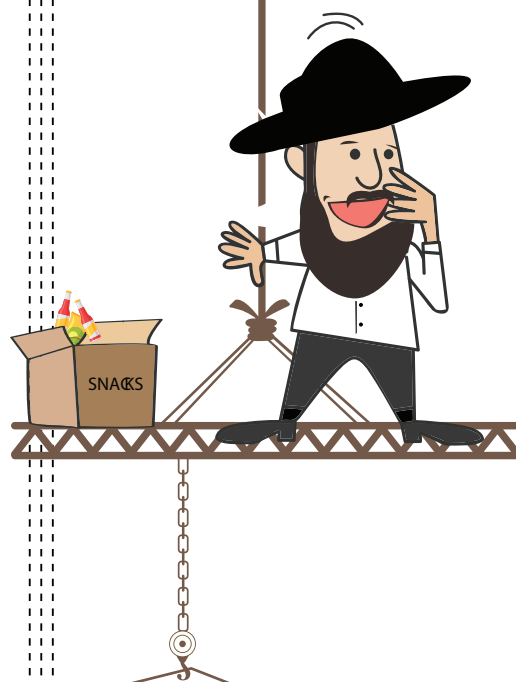
Warning: A BUILDING WILL AFFECT ALL ASPECTS OF YOUR SHLICHUS!

There's nothing like seeing a long-held dream actually rise to fruition. But be forewarned that the process of getting there is going to change your life. "This is a once in a lifetime project. If you want it to come out the way you want, you're going to have to be involved every step of the way!" says Rabbi Tiechtel. "The planning, the construction—it takes a toll on everything," warns Rabbi Zalmy Heber, shliach to Tacoma, Washington. "A shliach has to be ready for that. Expect it and embrace it."

Many shluchim tell of programs that had to be scaled back during the hectic months and years of the building process. There's simply not enough koach to do it all. And the family dynamic is of course impacted as well. The husband-wife relationship and the parent-child relationship are not immune to the stresses of the building process. Whether it's meetings with contractors, vendors, building

committees, potential donors, or interior designers, the shliach and shlucha will be away from their family more than usual. Take this into account, and make the children feel part of your shlichus. This can help avoid any resentment they may feel. Mrs. Shternie Deitsch, whose children were kept up to date with the building developments and would often visit the construction site, shares, "For the kids, there is a tremendous excitement. They find it fascinating to watch the building go up. They like to point out, 'This is going to be the office, here will be the Shul,' etc." Mrs. Esther Hadassah Ciment agrees. Her children were also very much involved and very proud of the building.

The shliach and shlucha need to pay extra attention to their sholom bayis and be prepared to support



"More than ever, you are a team. Through the creativity, the long hours, and time-sensitive decisions you hold on to bitachon and watch miracles happen."

B4 AND AFTER



BUILDING YOUR
CHABADHOUSE

WORKLOAD *to* 3 X WORKLOAD

each other during this taxing and nerve-wracking period. Routines will change, you may take on new, unexpected roles, and there will be many more demands on your time. “Do what you can to plan properly and keep life as balanced as possible. As with anything else, try to leave the stress outside of your house,” advises Mrs. Deitsch. “All the different strengths that you each have go into your building,” says Mrs. Tiechtel. “More than ever, you are a team. Through the creativity, the long hours, and time-sensitive decisions you hold on to bitachon and watch miracles happen.”

Once the process of the building is over, things don’t go back to the way they were before. “Your workload is going to triple,” predicts Rabbi Deitsch. And not just because of new financial commitments. “You have a building and you want it to be busy.” Rabbi Zalmen Wishedski, shliach to Basel, Switzerland concurs, citing a sicha from 13 Tishrei 5749 (see page 66), in which the Rebbe discusses three aspects of building a Chabad House, which he says were all actualized in the aftermath of their completed building. A building spurs the shluchim to do more, to add more to their programming both in quality and quantity. In addition, one good thing leads to another, and more events means more people coming through your doors, some of whom will rely on you for guidance and mentorship, all which exact even more time from an already-full day. One shliach advised that at this point in your shlichus, due to the growth brought on by a new building, you may have to consider hiring a new couple to assist in your shlichus.



YOU WILL BE LOOKED AT IN A COMPLETELY NEW LIGHT

All shluchim agree that a building takes Chabad to a completely new level in the eyes of the community. Rabbi Tiechtel uses the metaphor of minor league versus major league to describe the transformation. “Chabad is now an equal player in the community,” he says of his Chabad center. Rabbi Zalmen Wishedski adds, “Our status completely changed. The feeling is that you [Chabad] are a someone—someone who is here to stay.” No matter how well-run and professional, while Chabad is being run out of a storefront, hotel room, or the shluchim’s home, it is viewed as an amateur organization. Says Rabbi Deitsch, “You can’t compare the before and after—there is a completely different level of respect, engagement, and pride.”

Rabbi Tiechtel shares that that besides the governor, many communal leaders came to the building dedication. Whether it was out of curiosity or genuine interest, everyone was caught up in the excitement of the new addition to the community. People who were skeptical before quickly put aside their doubts. Rabbi Deitsch mentions the added benefit of this wave of

excitement. “People that come are proud of the building and want to show it to their friends. They want to invite them to family simchas—even to a Kiddush they are sponsoring.” Hence, he stresses, building a building is really about building a community. And a beautiful building serves that goal well.



CHANDLER, ARIZONA



TACOMA, WASHINGTON



NASHVILLE, TENNESSEE



PROPER PLANNING

When planning a building, so many are laser-focused on the here-and-now that they fail to take certain important details into account. Rabbi Tiechtel advises that shluchim think ahead. “If properly planned, certain expenses can be avoided later.” For example, when

“Rabbi Tiechtel advises to wait until the building is 100% complete, down to the last detail, which they did—and which added a unique element and made a big impression on those in attendance.”

pouring concrete, or doing footing, do it for future phases as well. Rabbi Ciment of Little Rock says that in hindsight, he wishes he would have built in a way that would allow for a second level—for growth. It’s easier than having to dig a second time.

One shliach shares that his electric bills went up by 1,000% (10 times!) per month. “Think about what it’s going to cost to run your building. Don’t go into debt that you cannot handle!” exhorts Rabbi Tiechtel. One clever shliach figured the future maintenance amount into his project budget. On maintaining the building, Rabbi Ciment underscores the importance of putting a proper maintenance plan in place. “Don’t let your building fall into disrepair. If your building is in use every day, it needs daily cleaning.”

It’s vitally important to keep the building account separate from your operating account. Rabbi Deitsch advises that as soon as you decide to go ahead with the building, an account should be opened that will be designated solely for the building. This will prevent problems later on, he says. He actually opened the account in a different bank (than the usual operating account), “so I would not be tempted to use that money. It was hard many times but I’m glad I stuck to it.”

Rabbi Tiechtel notes that many shluchim are in a rush to open their buildings and have their dedication ceremonies. The furnishings and finishing touches are oftentimes overlooked, to be attended to at a later date, once “things calm down.” Rabbi Tiechtel advises to wait until the building is 100% complete, down to the last detail, which they did—and which added a unique element and made a big impression on those in attendance.

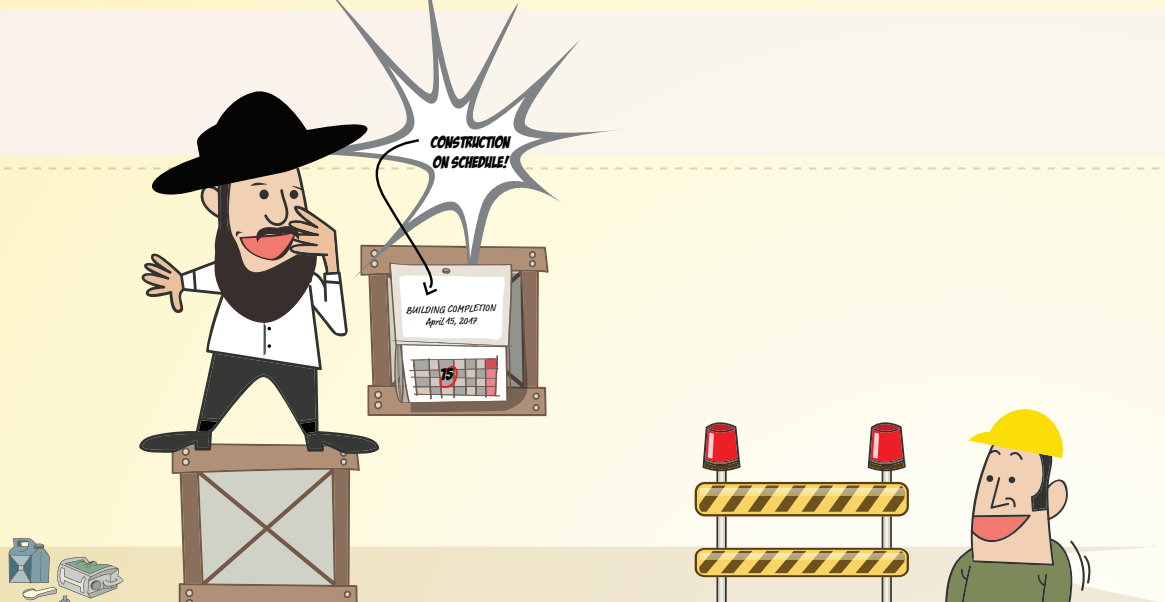


BUMPS

ANTICIPATE IN THE ROAD

It’s a shliach’s worst nightmare. A major donor comes forward with a pledge, the green light is given to go ahead with plans, and then the donor dies before paying his pledge. The children don’t want to honor the pledge and a long, drawn-out story ensues. There’s also the unexpected visit by the fire marshal who promptly stops construction until an overlooked and problematic building code is met. It’s not uncommon for it to take months, and in some cases years, for permit applications to slog through all of the red tape until they are finally approved.

From the get-go, shluchim should be aware that dealing with permits, legal issues, building codes, zoning boards, etc., is a long and thorny road. Rabbi Heber advises that one must “get familiar with local law and especially the Religious Land Use and Institutionalized Persons Act of 2000 (RLUIPA), a federal law that protects houses of worship and religious institutions from discrimination in zoning and landmarking laws. Proficiency in this law can be very helpful when seeking and filing for a variance, or if necessary, appealing



a decision by a board not to grant one. Planning and engineering for a mikvah can be especially tricky. Most shluchim who've built one share similar experiences of being surprised by the number of issues that arose.

In addition, there are the wishes of the major donors to contend with, which are not often flexible. One shliach shares that after painting the walls of the social hall in a specific color which was the interior designer had chosen, the individual who had paid for that room's dedication came for a tour and created quite a fuss when she adamantly insisted that the color be changed as it was not to her liking. Not being left with much choice, the paint job had to be redone. In another instance, Mrs. Shternie Deitsch tells of a main donor who was unwavering in his decision that two pillars be placed in a strategic area; his wishes needed to be fulfilled as well.

Rabbi Deitsch posits that patience during the process is essential. You will get there, "but maybe not as fast as you would have hoped for or liked," he says. So whatever your plans are, be forewarned and expect that things will never go exactly as planned. Doing so will make the inevitable less disappointing.



DON'T TAKE SHORTCUTS

The דרך קצרה is not necessarily as good as it seems. You may think you will save money by using a friend with some experience in the field who offers his services for free instead of a professional. Sometimes, it can work, and if it does you can consider yourself very lucky, but that is not the norm. "Use professionals," insists Rabbi Wishedski. "When you use professional people there is less of a chance of mistakes or setbacks." Adds Mrs. Ciment, "Surround yourself with people who are knowledgeable and ask advice. Don't think you are an expert." Many mentioned that they wish they would have taken the time to speak to (even) more shluchim before beginning to build for guidance and perspective.

With the burden of a possibly large mortgage loan looming, or in trying to meet a certain fundraising goal and coming up short, the pressure mounts to pare down original plans to accomplish the same with less. It's not always possible. Rabbi Tiechtel shares that one of the best pieces of advice he heard was, "If you can't build quality, don't build it at all." He strongly urges against using fake replacements for the real material, whatever it may be. "You want the building to be around for a long time," he reasons.

In another example of cost vs. quality, many shluchim concur that although the expense is great, a commercial kitchen is the way to go. Admittedly, there are more regulations and equipment expenditures, but when bringing in a caterer, and if you'd like to enable people to rent your space for simchos, it's especially advantageous. One shliach who didn't go that route, and thought he could get away with a quasi-commercial kitchen, acknowledges that when cooking in large quantities, things would be easier and much more comfortable for those involved, with the amenities of a commercial kitchen.

Another often-overlooked component is good insulation. Rabbi Ciment recommends expending as much as necessary for quality insulation. That's one expense that will save you money in the long run.



THERE WILL BE SKEPTICS – GET USED TO IT

As all shluchim know, whenever undertaking any endeavor, there will be naysayers. If this is true for establishing a Kiddush menu, how much more so when building a building. Rabbi Deitsch cautions that at the outset, the way you see the entire building campaign is different from the way the community sees it. Usually the shliach sees the bigger picture, and baa'lei batim will push for something smaller, which costs less money, and will often voice the common refrains: Why start from scratch? Why not buy an existing building? Make sure you have a good answer, and if you don't, perhaps you need to reconsider your proposal.

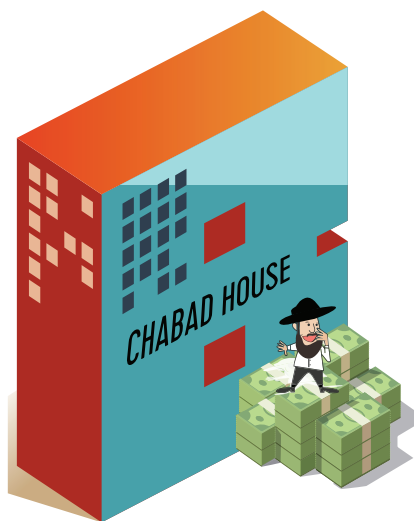
There will be a lot of skepticism, especially if the plans are grand. "It's important to come to a happy medium," says Rabbi Deitsch. If you don't want to compromise on the size of your project, then it's important to spend time meeting with people and having them understand things from your perspective until they are on board.

Rabbi Heber warns that when going from a small, intimate space to a large, impressive building, there will be those who complain about the loss of the "homey" feeling, and kvetch that they feel lost in a building

so large. Still, that point (as valid as it may be) can in no way outweigh the positive things that a building brings to the community.

Keep up a positive attitude if things aren't moving as quickly as planned, but expect the grumbling. Be confident and more importantly show that confidence to the community. It will rub off on them.

[Interestingly, the shluchim are divided on the benefits of a building committee composed of community members. For some, it proved to be a waste of time, dragging out the decision-making process and tangling matters, and for others, it turned out to be vital to the success of the building. Although at the end of the day, all shluchim agree that the bulk of the work and burden is on the shluchim's shoulders, it depends on your community and the lay leaders (and your delegating abilities) whether or not to "invest" in fostering this type of group.]



GETTING THEM TO GIVE

When it comes to fundraising for your building, holding on to assumptions about who will give and who won't can possibly sabotage your success. Rabbi Wishedski found that many people who were unwilling

to contribute to pe'ulos were surprisingly happy to donate towards the building campaign. "I think it's because they get the feeling that it's something substantial." He theorizes that some people who are more spiritual will be happy to give toward programs, but others need something more concrete—and a building dedication opportunity provides that.

You may find yourself pleasantly surprised in other ways, as well. One shliach shares that a woman who was known to be quite frugal came forward to pledge \$150,000 to the campaign. The shliach was shocked, sure he had not understood correctly, but she withdrew the money from her savings account and made good on her pledge. "You can't judge, and you can't underestimate. There are lots of surprises," counsels Rabbi Heber. During Chabad of Tacoma's campaign, he made sure to give everyone in the community a tour of the construction site, making each person feel special.

As with any fundraising effort, name recognition is a strong motivator. During their campaign, the Tiechtels published a quarterly magazine exclusively for the building which was mailed out to their entire mailing list. Containing updates, pictures, and a list of names of contributors during that quarter, the magazine encouraged new donors.

Rabbi Ciment attributes the fact that for him, most of the donors generously and eagerly supported the cause subsequent to personal connections established through learning Torah together. He shares that maintaining ongoing shiurim in Torah together creates a bond, where people felt they wanted to be a part of creating a home for Chabad in a significant way.

That said, it's important to make it easy for your ba'alei batim to donate. Rabbi Heber emphasizes the importance of opening a stock

account. Many people, he explains, feel more “able to part” with stocks (whose value has risen since their purchase) since they don’t necessarily view them as hard-earned cash. A Chabad stock account allows them to contribute in this way.

Another innovative initiative that Rabbi Heber credits is their “Gold to Bricks” drive, whereby women came together for a social evening and brought their old, broken, or unwanted jewelry which was then evaluated and exchanged for cash. People can’t always write out a check or dip into a savings account; it’s a matter of figuring out different avenues for giving and making them available for the people of your

community.

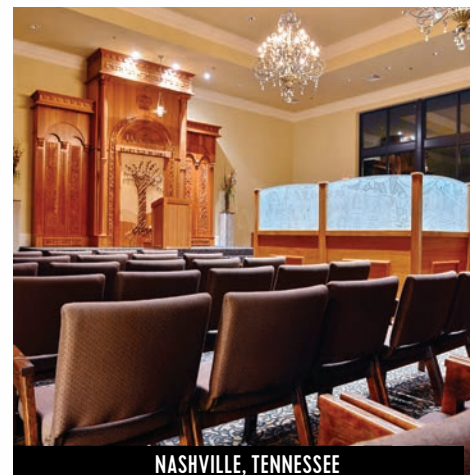
“We are very fortunate to have a brick from 770 and a rock from 770’s groundbreaking embedded in the wall of our building,” shares Mrs. Shternie Deitsch. “It really grounds you and makes you realize why you’re here and what you’re doing.” When it comes to building a Chabad center, no matter how we get there or the process we take in doing so, the ultimate goal for all shluchim is a mutual one—to bring kavod to the Rebbe and further the efforts of hafatzas hama’ayonos. The many brachos and siyata dishmaya involved in building were noted by all the shluchim interviewed; and the shluchim’s motivating drive behind

the initiative—often in a manner of l’chatchila ariber—serves as the keili to bring it all together. May we be zoche, very soon, to see Chabad centers the world over reestablished in Yerushalayim where they will be eternally and permanently joined to the Beis Hamikdash Hashlishi.

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NASHVILLE, TENNESSEE



NASHVILLE, TENNESSEE



LITTLE ROCK, ARKANSAS



BASEL, SWITZERLAND



ב"ה

בנין לכל שליח!

יש להשתדל ביותר שלכל מוסד ומוסר יהי בנין משלו, כלומר, לא רק בשכירות, אלא בנין שנמצא תחת בעלותו לגמרי.

וכן יש להשתדל בנוגע לשלוחים שבכל מקום ומקום שיהיו להם בנינים משלהם - עי"ז שכל שליח יגייס את הבעלי-בתים שיעזרו לו, ומוטב שהבעלי בתים עצמם יהיו ראשי המתעסקים בפעולות הבנין, או רכישת הבנינים.

ומה טוב שייבנו (או יקנו) מלכתחילה בנין גדול (ריבוי חדרים וכו') יותר מכדי הצורך בהוה, כי, זה גופא (שיש חלק בהבנין שלא משתמשים בו) יעורר להוסיף בפעולות ביתר שאת וביתר עוז, שאז יצטרכו להשתמש בכל חלקי הבנין בשלימותו ממש (לא רק רובו, ג' רבעים, או אפילו תשע עשיריות, עד ל-99 אחוז, אלא כולו ממש) - ע"ד שכלי שרת מקדשים מלאים דוקא. ולאח"ז - יצטרכו להוסיף ולבנות עוד ועוד, שהרי, "מי שיש לו מנה רוצה מאתיים, מאתיים רוצה ד' מאות"; וכן הלאה.

ויש להוסיף, שמלבד התועלת בהרחבת הפעולות כו', הרי, עצם העובדה של בניית בנינים מוסיפה כבוד לבעלי הבנין, המוסד או השליח, ובמילא, מתייחסים אליהם בדרך ארץ יתירה, ולא עוד, אלא, שי- רצו וישתדלו ללמוד מהנהגתם, להוסיף בקיום התומ"צ כו', בראותם שע"י הנהגה זו הגיעו לבניית בנינים כו', וכבר אמרו חז"ל "לעולם יעסוק אדם בתורה ומצוות אפילו שלא לשמה, שמתוך שלא לשמה בא לשמה".

ומובן, שע"י יתוסף בכבודן של ישראל אצל אוה"ע, ובודאי תהי' לזה השפעה בנוגע לפעולה עם אוה"ע שיקיימו מצוות בני-נח (כפס"ד הרמב"ם)...

ויה"ר שהפעולות דבניות בתים - בתוככי כל שאר הפעולות בעניני התומ"צ, אשר, ע"י "מצוה אחת, הכריע את עצמו ואת כל העולם כולו לכף זכות וגרם לו ולהם תשועה והצלה" - ימהרו ויזרזו עוד יותר את הבנין הכי עיקרי של הקב"ה, בית המקדש השלישי, "מקדש אדני-י כוננו ידיך", שירד ויתגלה בביהמ"ק וברוש" לים של מטה, בארצנו הקדושה.

ואז, יקחו גם את כל הבנינים הנ"ל מחוץ לארץ לארץ ישראל, וכן הבתים הפרטיים דבני"י שנעשו ראויים להשראת השכינה, "ושכנתי בתוכם", שגם הם יקבעו בארץ ישראל, שתהי' אז בשלימותה, כולל גם "ירחיב ה' אלקיך את גבולך".

((משיחת ש"פ האזינו תשמ"ט (תורת מנחם תשמ"ט ח"א עמ' 94-95))

NASHVILLE, TENNESSEE



TACOMA, WASHINGTON



TACOMA, WASHINGTON





NASHVILLE, TENNESSEE



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TACOMA, WASHINGTON



CHANDLER, ARIZONA



BASEL, SWITZERLAND



CHANDLER, ARIZONA



EACH MOSAD SHOULD TRY TO HAVE ITS OWN BUILDING, i.e., not merely to rent one out but to have one that is entirely in its possession.

Similarly, shlichim in every location should try to have their own buildings. This should be done by each shliach enlisting his baalei batim to assist him. It is recommended that the baalei batim themselves should be the leading individuals involved in constructing or acquiring the buildings.

An even better idea would be to build or purchase a large building (with many rooms, etc.), more than what is needed at present. The fact that part of the building remains unutilized will arouse [the mosad or shliach] to increase in pe'ulos even more, so that every single part of the building will be utilized (not just most of it, three-quarters, 90%, or even 99%). When that happens, it will be necessary to increase and build even more, because “one who possesses one maneh [100 zuz] desires 200, one who possesses 200 desires 400,” and so on.

Another point: Besides for the benefit of expanding pe'ulos, the actual construction of a building increases the honor of the mosad or shliach, causing others to treat them with extra respect. What's more, [people] will wish to learn from their conduct and increase in fulfilling Torah and mitzvos, seeing that people who acted in this way attained such achievements. [Although this is not the best motive,] Chazal teach us that “one should always perform Torah and mitzvos even if he is doing so shelo lishmah, because this will lead him to perform them lishmah.”

Furthermore, this will also add in the respect of gentile nations toward Bnei Yisroel, facilitating our efforts to influence them to perform the sheva mitzvos bnei noach....

May it be Hashem's will that the pe'ulos of constructing buildings (together with all the other pe'ulos in matters of Torah and mitzvos, each one of which has the ability to tip the scale and bring a yeshu'ah to the entire world) will additionally hasten the revelation of Hashem's most important building—the third Beis Hamikdash—which will descend onto the Beis Hamikdash below in Eretz Yisroel.

We will then take all of these buildings fromchutz la'aretz to Eretz Yisroel, as well as our private houses that have become fit for the shechinah to rest upon them. They, too, will be established in Eretz Yisroel, which will then be complete and have expanded borders.

Sichah of Shabbos Parshas Ha'azinu, 5749 (Toras Menachem 5749, Vol. 1, pp. 94-95) 

